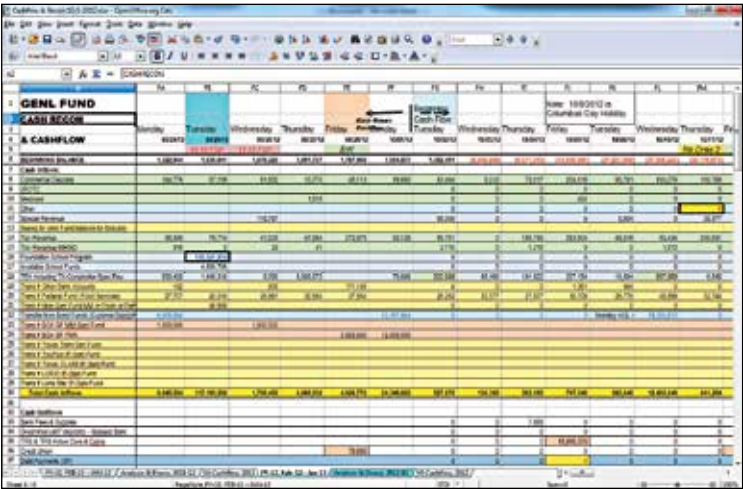


confused with a text editor. The latter only allows editing and creation of plain text documents. Word processors usually come with features such as password protection for files, track changes and grammar checking abilities.

Spreadsheet software

A ‘spreadsheet’, technically, is a table of values arranged in rows and columns with each value having a possibility of having a predefined relationship with other values. Spreadsheet applications (usually referred to simply as spreadsheets) are computer programs that simulate physical spreadsheets by capturing, displaying, and manipulating data arranged in rows and columns. In a spreadsheet application, each value resides in a cell, which is at the intersection of the corresponding column and row. The spreadsheet is one of the most popular uses of the personal computer. In fact, it has been deemed to be the original killer app for personal com-



Apache OpenOffice spreadsheet

puters – early spreadsheet programs were largely responsible for the growth in popularity and usage of computers as business tools. Thanks to their ability to perform mathematical operations, spreadsheets are often used to store financial data. Spreadsheets are also used to include graphing or charting data for identifying trends, or to sort and filter data to find specific information.